

S06-02 - The Relay Spire Hook

Player text

The Custodian leads you out of the treehouse, out of the forest itself, to look down on the green expanse from above. Twisting stone spires break through the treeline, each with a flame flickering in its tower like a beacon. "There's a relay out west," she says, "maybe a few hours. You might have felt it on the way in: its light was weaker than it should be. I think something's wrong with its Keeper, and I fear what happens if that fire goes out." She studies the horizon. "When you're ready, come back. I'll give you my map, so you can make it there safe. It's good to have heroes in the preserve again."

Public objective

Learn what is stirring west, and decide whether you leave that door open.

GM goal

The Custodian reveals another relay spire may be failing.

GM notes

- The Relay is seen and described, not entered.
- If epilogue_tone is pyrrhic or tragic, the hook feels like unfinished business rather than excitement.

GM script

Say: "One more thing on the horizon. Not tonight unless you want it tonight: a fire going dim, a Keeper in trouble, and a map waiting if you ever come back."

State controls

- report_choice Report Choice select unresolved file-honest spin-corporate refuse withhold-the-truth
- relay_hook_accepted Relay Hook Accepted checkbox
- epilogue_tone Epilogue Tone select triumphant bittersweet pyrrhic tragic
- hidden_hook_discovered Hidden Hook Discovered checkbox
- sequel_direction Sequel Direction select relay hidden both undecided
- strixwolf_disposition Strixwolf Disposition select unresolved calm hostile killed
- strixwolf_outcome Strixwolf Outcome select unresolved calmed helped avoided attacked killed
- strixwolf_trust Strixwolf Trust number 3
- strixwolf_blood_debt Strixwolf Blood Debt checkbox
- bramble_outcome Bramble Outcome select unresolved killed captured spared negotiated escaped let_cargo
- bramble_truth_learned Bramble Truth Learned checkbox

- package_status Package Status select held lost
- hush_trust Hush Trust select low neutral high
- custodian_route Custodian Route select unknown safe dangerous
- ward_awareness Ward Awareness select none seed aware
- festival_boon Festival Boon select none charm favor market_find goodwill
- hush_clues Hush Clues select none custodian_route ward_seed corporate_seam farm_seed
market_rumor multiple
- custodian_trust Custodian Trust select low neutral high
- ward_stability Ward Stability select fragile stable
- ritual_prep Ritual Prep select unready ready
- keystone_understanding Keystone Understanding select surface deep
- ritual_outcome Ritual Outcome select unresolved clean costly pyrrhic
- protected_whom Protected Whom select unresolved custodian party hush shared
- custodian_fate Custodian Fate select unresolved well drained dying
- rewards_granted Rewards Granted checkbox

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